

Claude Code Cheat Sheet

Terminal-based AI coding agent by Anthropic. Reads your codebase, plans, edits, tests, commits, and deploys. Your job: be a great manager, not a typist. When in doubt, do everything from inside Claude Code.

Install & Go

```
npm install -g @anthropic-ai/claude-code && cd your-project && claude
```

CLAUDE.md — Project Memory

Claude reads this every session. Keep under 200 lines: stack, commands, conventions, do-not rules. Use @path imports for longer docs. `.claude/rules/` for file-scoped rules. Generate it: "Read this repo and generate a CLAUDE.md."

Permission Modes (Shift+Tab) — Auto is Now Default

Mode	Runs Without Asking	When to Use
default	Reads only	Starting out, sensitive repos
acceptEdits	File edits + safe filesystem	Review via git diff after
plan	Reads only (proposes first)	Exploring before changing
auto (now default)	Everything + safety classifier	Flow state. Sweet spot.
bypassPermissions	Everything. No safety net.	Disposable containers ONLY

Models — /model to switch

Model	Use For	Cost
Sonnet 4.6 (default)	90% of work. Code gen, refactoring, tests, debugging.	\$\$
Opus 4.7	Deep reasoning. When Sonnet loops. 10+ file refactors.	\$\$\$\$
Haiku 4.5	Mechanical cleanup. Renaming. Cheap parallel subagents.	\$

Skills, Commands & Subagents

Skills: Markdown files with knowledge/workflows. Claude loads automatically when relevant, or you invoke with `/name`.

Commands: A `.md` file = a `/slash-command`. Create when you repeat yourself. Ideas: `/commit`, `/pr`, `/deploy`.

Subagents: Isolated context, own window. `/agents` to define, `Ctrl+B` backgrounds. Returns summary only, saves your context.

Dynamic Workflows: Claude writes a script orchestrating many subagents for large-scale work (audits, codebase-wide reviews).

Hooks, Plugins & MCP

Hooks: Auto-run on events (`edit/commit/push`). Pre-commit lint, post-edit format, security scans.

Plugins: Bundle skills+hooks+MCP into one package. `claude plugin add <git-url>`. Marketplace available.

MCP (/mcp): Connect to AWS, databases, GitHub, Docker, web search, browser, and more.

Claude Code Cheat Sheet (cont.)

Routines & /ultrareview

/loop: Scheduled tasks (cron-like). Set intervals in minutes/hours/days. Use for periodic review, monitoring, batch updates.

/ultrareview: Fleet of cloud bug-hunting agents. Findings land in your CLI. Run before merging critical changes.

/run & /verify: Launch your app to confirm features work. /verify = build + run for correctness checks.

Essential Commands

Command	What It Does
/plan	Research + propose before coding
/compact	Compress context (saves tokens)
/clear	Reset conversation
/code-review	Built-in code review
/ultrareview	Cloud multi-agent deep review
/loop	Schedule recurring routines
/agents	Create/manage subagents
/subtask	Spawn in-session worker
/tasks	View background work
/mcp	Connect external services
/chrome	Browser tool (visual verification)
/model	Switch between Sonnet / Opus / Haiku

Shortcuts

Shift+Tab Cycle permission modes • **Ctrl+B** Background subagent • **Ctrl+G** Open plan in editor • **Ctrl+Y/N** Accept/Reject edits

Agent SDK — Automate Programmatically

Python & TypeScript. Same tools as Claude Code, for scripts, CI/CD, and background workers. Auto-review PRs, batch multiple repos, overnight execution, queue-based autonomous workers.

Cost-Saving Tips

Tip	Why
/compact when context grows	Fewer tokens = lower cost
Default to Sonnet	5-10x cheaper than Opus
Haiku for parallel grunt work	Cheap parallel > expensive serial
Good CLAUDE.md	Less back-and-forth = fewer tokens
/plan before big tasks	Planning prevents costly rework
SDK + Haiku for batch CI	Automated, cheap, no human needed

Power Patterns

- **Docs:** "Generate CLAUDE.md + per-module docs for any AI agent to be productive in 5 min."
- **Bug fix:** "/plan — Highest-severity finding. Fix it. Test. Open PR. Run full suite."
- **Parallel:** "Subagents: 1) Map API endpoints 2) DB schema 3) Auth flow. Summaries only."
- **SDK CI:** "GitHub Action: Claude Code auto-reviews every PR and suggests fixes."
- **Security:** "Read security-playbook.md and follow it."
- **Overnight:** "Fix all TODO comments. Run tests after each. Commit separately."

Team: .claude/ is version-controlled. Commit = team gets same commands, skills, hooks, plugins. CLAUDE.md = shared project memory. ~/.claude/ = personal config. Share plugins via git.